



Lauren Sanchez, Katy Perry... and one giant step BACK for womankind **Jan Moir**

PAGES 4-5



Union rejects Angela Rayner's plea to end Birmingham crisis

By **Claire Duffin**

LABOUR was humiliated by its top union backer yesterday as bin workers voted to prolong crippling strikes.

Deputy Prime Minister Angela Rayner had pleaded with Unite to accept a 'significantly improved offer' to end the month-long crisis, which has seen rats running through mountains of bin bags.

But Unite members in Birmingham voted overwhelmingly against the council's 'totally inadequate' proposal – meaning strikes which have left 21,000 tons of rubbish piling up on the streets of England's second city will grind on.

The rejection brought pressure on ministers to get tough on their 'paymasters', with accusations that Labour's inaction was taking Britain 'back to the 1970s'.

Conservative West Midlands MP Wendy Morton said the rats – dubbed Squeaky Blinders after the TV drama set in the city – would be 'dancing in the streets'.

Ms Morton said: 'This really shows yet again that Labour-led Birmingham Council and this Labour Government are failing residents and our region.'

'They need to get a grip, stop blaming others, and face the unions – their paymasters.'

Tory local government spokesman Kevin Hollinrake added: 'Yet again, Labour

BIN STRIKE GRINDS ON AS LABOUR HUMILIATED

Turn to Page 6